

requirements (PHP 4.3 and MySQL 4.1.2) and that they have the `mod_rewrite` Apache module configured.

1.2.1 Apache

Apache is an open source web server that comes bundled with most Linux distributions. It is, by far, the most commonly used web server, and WordPress was designed perfectly for it. There is no minimum requirement for WordPress and Apache. The oldest version of Apache currently in use is Apache 1.3 and it works as well as Apache 2.2, which is the most stable version.

1.2.2 Internet Information Services

Because PHP can be loaded into the Microsoft server product, Internet Information Services (IIS), WordPress can be run on it. IIS is not the optimal solution, but it works in scenarios where other server products are not available or permitted. IIS is bundled with Microsoft Server products as part of Active Directory. The trickiest issues with WordPress on IIS are permalinks.

On Ubuntu, the demonstration platform here, the previous command makes `mod_rewrite` available to Apache but it won't enable it. To do that, you need to make sure Apache knows how to load it. Follow these steps to create a symbolic link (better understood as a shortcut to Windows users) and restart the web server:

1. From the Linux command line, type `ln -s /etc/apache2/mods-available/rewrite.load /etc/apache2/mods-enabled/rewrite.load`. If you're using Apache 1.3, simply replace `apache2` with `apache`.
2. Type `/etc/init.d/apache2 restart` for the changes to take effect.
3. Type `apache2ctl -M` to verify that `rewrite_module` is in the list of available Apache modules.

The nice thing is that it is highly unlikely you will need to do this. On other variants of Linux, it is much easier to enable `mod_rewrite`. Ubuntu and Debian modularise the Apache configuration file (sometimes called `apache2.conf`, but typically called `httpd.conf`) and break the portions of the configuration into separate files. Usually, it's one big file that can be edited. The key bit that Apache needs is a line that says `LoadModule rewrite_module /usr/lib/apache2/modules/mod_rewrite.so` where `/usr/lib/apache2/modules/mod_rewrite.so` is actually the path to the compiled `mod_rewrite.so` file.